

# **The AI Prompting Strategy: "Micro-Systems"**

*To make the transition from a massive written document into structured prompts that coding models can actually execute, you need to break the design down into modular, isolated systems. If you throw a 50-page document at a coding model, it will hallucinate or lose context.*

*Here is how to structure your document into a developer blueprint and start prompting your AI coding assistants.*

## **The AI Prompting Strategy: "Micro-Systems"**

When you start generating code, you want to prompt for one isolated feature at a time. The best way to do this is to establish a **Unified Game State Manager** first. This is the backbone that tracks player money, owned properties, and current mission progress.

### **1. The Economy & Asset Core (The Priority System)**

Since the defining mechanic of *Vice City* is buying businesses to progress, this should be your first technical build. You can prompt a coding model to write a decoupled, data-driven system.

- **Data Structure:** A script that defines what a "Property" is (ID, Name, Cost, Daily Revenue, Mission Locked Status, Operational Status).
- **The Blueprint Prompt to use with a Coding Model:** "Write a C# script for Unity [or C++ for Unreal] that handles an Asset Property System for an open-world game. I need a PropertyManager that tracks an array of buyable businesses. Each business needs variables for purchasePrice, dailyRevenue, isPurchased, and missionsCompleted. Include functions for PurchaseProperty(int propertyID) which checks if the player has enough money, deducts it, and sets isPurchased to true, and a time-based function that adds dailyRevenue to the player's total balance every 24 in-game hours for all owned properties."

### **2. The Region-Specific Weather & Environment Loop**

To capture the distinct atmosphere of the South Coast, you need a system that handles environmental changes dynamically, shifting between dense fog, heavy coastal rain, and clear days.

- **The Technical Logic:** A state machine that controls volumetric fog density, ambient audio triggers (like a foghorn playing on a loop when visibility drops below 20%), and road friction multipliers (reducing tire grip during a Nor'easter storm).
- **The Blueprint Prompt to use with a Coding Model:** "Create a dynamic weather controller script. It should cycle between four states: Clear, Dense Fog, Coastal Rain, and Blizzard. When in the 'Dense Fog' state, it should

gradually increase the scene's volumetric fog density to maximum over 60 seconds and trigger an audio source loop for a distant foghorn. When in 'Blizzard' or 'Rain' states, it should pass a float value to the player's vehicle physics script to reduce tire lateral friction by 40% to simulate slick, slushy coastal roads."

**Recommended Folder & Architecture Setup**

Before generating code, set up a clean directory structure in your project to keep your AI-generated scripts organized.

| Directory       | Purpose                                                  | Key Scripts to Generate Next               |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| /Core           | Global game logic, saving/loading, and player stats.     | GameManager.cs, PlayerEconomy.cs           |
| /World          | Weather, time-of-day cycles, and region tracking.        | WeatherController.cs, RegionZoneTrigger.cs |
| /Systems/Assets | The business ownership and revenue generation mechanics. | Property.cs, RevenueGenerator.cs           |
| /Controllers    | Player movement, vehicle physics, and input handling.    | VehicleSuspension.cs, PlayerInteraction.cs |

**Next Steps**

To keep moving forward effectively, choose one specific cornerstone from your document to bring to life first.

Would you like to start by generating the complete architecture for the **Player Economy and Asset Ownership system**, or do you want to map out the technical logic for the **Vehicle Physics modification system** (handling how cars drive on slick cobblestone and flooded docks)?

# **Player Economy and Asset Ownership system.**

Let’s dive straight into the **Player Economy and Asset Ownership system**.

Since this is the foundational progression loop for taking over the South Coast, getting the data structure right from day one is critical. If the underlying math and state management are messy, the entire empire-building fantasy collapses.

When architecting this, it helps to treat the gameplay loop exactly like targeting and acquiring distressed commercial real estate. The player identifies an underperforming or distressed asset (like the abandoned Fall River textile mill), acquires it, performs "value-add" operations (missions) to clear out operational friction, and stabilizes the property to generate a reliable, high-yield daily return.

Here is the complete architectural blueprint for how to structure this system using a relational, data-driven approach.

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**1. The Core Data Models (The Schema)**

Instead of hardcoding individual properties into the game world, you want a decoupled database approach. Whether you are using a strictly typed language like C# in Unity or setting up a local SQLite/PostgreSQL backend for a custom engine, the data structures should look like this:

**Table 1: The PlayerWallet** This needs to be a strictly protected singleton or central manager so that UI elements, shops, and properties all read from the exact same source of truth.

- CurrentBalance (Float/Int): The player's total liquid cash.
- TotalLifetimeEarned (Float/Int): Useful for unlocking high-tier achievements or ending scenarios.

**Table 2: The AssetProperty** This data model holds the state of every buyable business in the game.

| Variable Name | Data Type | Description                                |
|---------------|-----------|--------------------------------------------|
| PropertyID    | String    | Unique identifier (e.g., PROP_NB_SEAFOOD). |

| Variable Name       | Data Type | Description                                                                     |
|---------------------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DisplayName         | String    | Player-facing name (e.g., "Pier 3 Scallop Processing").                         |
| PurchasePrice       | Int       | The upfront capital required to acquire the asset.                              |
| BaseDailyYield      | Int       | The passive income generated every 24 in-game hours before upgrades.            |
| IsOwned             | Boolean   | Checks if the player has successfully acquired the deed.                        |
| IsDistressed        | Boolean   | If true, the property generates no yield until a specific mission is completed. |
| CurrentUpgradeLevel | Int       | Tracks how many value-add missions the player has completed (0 to 3).           |

## 2. The Logic Managers

To keep your codebase clean, separate the *data* from the *actions*. You will build three primary managers to handle the economy loop.

**The Acquisition Engine** This script handles the transaction logic when a player walks up to a "For Sale" sign outside a property.

- **Step 1:** The script checks `Property.IsOwned`. If false, display the `PurchasePrice` on the UI.
- **Step 2:** The player presses the buy input. The engine calls `PlayerWallet.CurrentBalance`.
- **Step 3:** If the balance is greater than or equal to the price, deduct the

funds, trigger a cinematic fanfare, and set `Property.IsOwned` to `true`.

- **Step 4:** Send an event flag to the Mission Manager to unlock the specific property missions.

**The Yield & Revenue Generator** This is the heartbeat of the empire. It listens to the global in-game clock and distributes cash.

- **The Tick:** Every time the in-game clock hits 00:00 (midnight), this manager loops through the `AssetProperty` database.
- **The Filter:** It filters strictly for properties where `IsOwned == true` and `IsDistressed == false`.
- **The Calculation:** It calculates the payout based on `BaseDailyYield` multiplied by a modifier tied to the `CurrentUpgradeLevel`.
- **The Drop:** It spawns a physical cash pickup at the property's physical location in the world, or directly deposits it into the `PlayerWallet` (depending on how hardcore you want the mechanics to be).

**The Margin-Leak System (Dynamic Events)** To keep the mid-to-late game engaging, the assets cannot be entirely passive. You must introduce operational friction.

- **The Trigger:** A random number generator rolls every in-game week.
- **The Event:** A property might get raided by a rival faction (like the Providence LCN offshoot) or targeted by corrupt union bosses.
- **The Penalty:** The property is temporarily flagged as `IsDistressed = true`, immediately halting its daily yield. The player must physically travel to the location and resolve the combat/intimidation event to restore cash flow and prevent margin-leak.

### 3. Implementation Steps for the AI Model

When you are ready to generate the actual boilerplate code from your AI assistant, keep the prompt focused strictly on these structural components. Ask the coding model to build the exact classes defined above.

#### Example Prompt for your Coding Model:

"Write the foundational C# architecture for an open-world property management system. Create a struct/class for `AssetProperty` containing `PropertyID`, `PurchasePrice`, `BaseDailyYield`, `IsOwned`, and

CurrentUpgradeLevel. Then, write a RevenueManager script that runs a daily timer. When the timer hits zero, it should iterate through a list of all AssetProperty objects, check if they are owned, calculate the total yield based on the base yield multiplied by the upgrade level, and output the total daily revenue generated to the console."

Building this backend architecture first ensures that when you finally place the 3D model of that historic Portuguese bakery into the game engine, the logic dictating its purchase price and daily revenue is already hardened and ready to attach.



**“Thinking “**

Here is a highly detailed, comprehensive prompt you can use to feed into an AI (like a narrative generator, game design assistant, or concept art tool) to conceptualize this game. You can copy and paste the text below the divider directly into your AI tool of choice.

**System Prompt: Game Pitch & Design Document Generator**

**Role & Objective:** You are an elite Lead Game Director and World Builder at Rockstar Games. Your task is to generate a comprehensive Game Design Document (GDD) for a complete remake of *Grand Theft Auto: Vice City*. However, there is one massive twist: the game is strictly relocated from Miami to Boston, Massachusetts, and its surrounding neighborhoods in the 1980s.

You must perfectly preserve the mechanical soul, progression systems, and cinematic 1980s tone of *Vice City*, while providing an impeccably accurate, heavily researched, and deeply satirical representation of the Bay State.

**Core Directives:**

1. **The Vibe:** Maintain *Vice City*'s 1986 setting, cinematic crime-drama storytelling, and neon-drenched nostalgia, but adapt it to a gritty, mob-run, cold-weather 1980s Boston.
2. **The Mechanics:** Keep the core progression loop of *Vice City*: a voiced protagonist who arrives in a new city, starts from nothing, takes over the local underworld, and builds an empire by purchasing and managing "Asset" properties that unlock missions.
3. **The Geography:** Accurately represent the layout, landmarks, and distinct neighborhood cultures of Boston and greater Massachusetts.

Please structure your output using the following mandatory sections:

## 1. Title & Logline

- Create a catchy, Rockstar-style title (e.g., *Grand Theft Auto: Commonwealth*, *Grand Theft Auto : Beantown*).
- Write a one-paragraph logline detailing the protagonist's arrival in Boston in 1986, their initial betrayal, and their goal

to conquer the city's underworld.

## 2. World Map & Geography (The Massachusetts Translation)

Map the sunny islands of Vice City to the peninsulas and neighborhoods of Boston. Detail the distinct areas of the map:

- **The Urban Core:** The North End (Italian Mafia stronghold, tight streets, brick buildings), Downtown Crossing, and the Financial District. Incorporate parodies of Faneuil Hall and the ongoing planning of the "Big Dig."
- **The Gritty Boroughs:** South Boston ("Southie") and Charlestown. Deeply tied to the 80s Irish Mob, triple-decker houses, gritty docks, and industrial zones.
- **The Academic District:** Cambridge (across the parody of the Charles River). Ivy League snobbery, rowing clubs, tech nerds (80s MIT equivalent), and student protests.
- **The Aristocratic Elite (Starfish Island Equivalent):** The wealthy, sprawling manors of Cape Cod or Martha's Vineyard (accessible via bridges or ferries), featuring Kennedy-esque political dynasties and old money.
- **Landmarks:** Include parodies of Fenway Park (maybe called "Green Monster Stadium"), the CITGO sign, the Boston Common, and the MBTA public transit system (the "T"), which the player can ride or hijack.

## 3. Art Direction & Atmosphere (Cold Neon)

- Explain how to achieve the *Vice City* aesthetic in a northern climate. Describe "Cold Neon"—glowing signs reflecting off slushy, snowy streets, or rain-slicked cobblestone.
- Describe the 80s Boston fashion: heavy puffer jackets, tracksuits, prep-school sweaters, heavily hair-sprayed big hair, and thick mustaches.
- Detail the weather cycle: Nor'easter blizzards that affect driving handling, crisp autumn days, and gray, foggy harbor mornings.

## 4. Factions & The Underworld

Detail the gangs the protagonist will fight, work for, and

eventually overthrow. Replace the Cartels and Cubans/Haitians with accurate 1980s Boston equivalents:

- **The Irish Syndicate:** Based in Southie (a nod to the Winter Hill Gang). Brutal, secretive, heavily involved in racketeering and corrupt FBI connections.
- **The Italian La Cosa Nostra:** Based in the North End. Traditional, flashy, running restaurants, waste management, and illegal gambling.
- **The Corrupt Establishment:** Dirty politicians from Beacon Hill, corrupt local sports commissioners, and crooked state troopers.

## **5. Progression & Asset Properties**

Recreate the *Vice City* mechanic where the player buys businesses to unlock mission strands and generate daily revenue. Provide 5 specific Boston-themed businesses the player can buy. Examples must include:

- **An Irish Dive Bar in Southie.**
- **A corrupt Seafood Distribution Warehouse on the docks (parody of New England fisheries).**
- **A failing minor-league hockey arena.**
- **A historic but bankrupt brewery. Detail the unique missions required to make each property profitable.**

## **6. Vehicles & Audio**

- **Vehicles:** Describe 80s muscle cars, rusted snowplows (which can be used as weapons), preppy imported European sports cars in Cambridge, and stolen Duck Tour boats.
- **Radio Stations:** Outline 4 distinct radio stations. Include:
  - **A classic rock station featuring Boston/Aerosmith/J. Geils Band parodies.**
  - **A moody 80s Synth-Pop/New Wave station.**
  - **A chaotic, aggressive Local Sports Talk Radio station (mocking the intense Boston sports fan culture).**
  - **A corrupt, hyper-partisan political talk radio show.**

**Formatting Constraints:** Make the GDD highly detailed, using bolding, bullet points, and an energetic, satirical tone

characteristic of the *Grand Theft Auto* franchise. Ground every ridiculous satirical element in true Massachusetts history and geography.

The user has shared a detailed prompt asking me to create a Game Design Document for a GTA-style game set in 1980s Massachusetts, and I'm evaluating whether this is an appropriate creative task to help with. It appears to be a satirical parody project rather than something problematic. ly fine. Given that Nic is based in the Fall River/Brockton area and values energetic, scannable markdown over dense prose, I should lean into this as a fun creative project that blends his local knowledge with his gaming interests. Since this is a substantial, multi-section Game Design Document, it belongs in an artifact rather than inline. I'm weighing whether to create this as a markdown artifact file or keep it inline, considering the mobile context and that the user wants a comprehensive, detailed document they can reference and share. The instructions emphasize checking the relevant SKILL.md before creating files, so I should look at what's available before deciding on the best approach. I'll create this as a markdown artifact since it's long-form reference content the user will want to save and reference. Now I need to focus on getting the content right—drawing on real knowledge of Fall River, New

Bedford, and Cape Cod in the 1980s to create an authentic satirical GTA-style guide. Fall River earned its “Spindle City” nickname from its textile mills, and I should weave in those real historical and cultural details alongside the satirical tone. arine), USS Joseph P. Kennedy Jr. (destroyer), and PT boats — perfect for the hijacked battleships angle. Lizzie Borden is another goldmine for satire, with the 1892 axe murders and the actual house being a tourist attraction. I should also note the Quequechan River and its falls (which is where Fall River gets its name), plus the Portuguese cultural elements like malasadas, chouriço, linguiça, massa sovada, bifanas, and caldo verde, along with the Portuguese Feast and Holy Ghost celebrations.

The Government Center’s brutalist concrete complex, Route 79’s elevated highway (now partially demolished), Kennedy Park, and the distinctive Fall River accent all add local flavor. The neighborhoods like Maplewood, the Flint, the Highlands, and Corky Row, plus B.M.C. Durfee High School round out the geography. There’s also the darker angle of the Patriarca crime family’s influence extending into the city from Rhode Island. New Bedford’s “Whaling City” nickname is historically accurate — it was the world’s whaling capital and by the 1980s became America’s wealthiest commercial fishing port, particularly for scallops, consistently ranking as the top US fishing port by value.

The cobblestone streets in the historic waterfront district, the Seamen's Bethel and Whaling Museum tied to Moby-Dick, and the dramatic New Bedford Harbor Hurricane Protection Barrier (one of the largest stone structures on the East Coast) are all real landmarks. The fishing fleet with draggers and scallopers, fish processing houses, and the significant Portuguese and Cape Verdean populations — New Bedford has the largest Cape Verdean community in the US — are defining features of the city.

Beyond that, there's the Whaling Museum and lightship, Fort Taber at Clark's Point, Buttonwood Park with its zoo, and the working waterfront co-op. The city also has a documented history with drug smuggling in the 1980s, with cocaine trafficking through the fishing fleet, which grounds that premise in reality. I'm steering clear of the 1983 Big Dan's tavern case since that's a real tragedy that became the basis for "The Accused" — not something to satirize directly.

For Cape Cod, I'm thinking about the two bridges spanning the Cape Cod Canal — the Sagamore and Bourne bridges, which are notorious for summer traffic and basically a regional meme. The Kennedy compound in Hyannis Port is perfect for the aristocratic elite angle, along with yacht clubs, old money, and the natural landscape of dunes and lighthouses scattered across the peninsula. The accent, Cape Verdean food and music traditions, and the arts district round out the cultural texture.

I'm also mapping out the specific towns and institutions that define the area — Woods Hole with its oceanographic research institute that discovered the Titanic in the 80s, Wellfleet for oysters, Provincetown, and the ferry routes to Martha's Vineyard and Nantucket. The summer people versus year-round residents dynamic, the preppy aesthetic with Nantucket reds and Lilly Pulitzer, Cape Cod League baseball, and the cranberry bogs all contribute to the regional identity. Now I'm adding the food culture — clam shacks and lobster rolls are central to Cape Cod, along with the distinctive non-rhotic accent. Dunkin' Donuts, founded in Quincy, is ubiquitous throughout New England, and I'm noting the Patriarca crime family connection, with Raymond Patriarca controlling the New England mob from Providence until his death in 1984, when his son took over — this ties directly to the Providence LCN offshoot mentioned in the scenario.

I'm also considering Brockton's boxing legacy with fighters like Rocky Marciano and Marvelous Marvin Hagler, which fits the user's location, and the industrial landmarks like Brayton Point Power Station in Somerset near Fall River, though the iconic cooling towers came later in the 2000s rather than the 1980s setting. Bristol County fishing heritage — the Georges Bank disputes, the cod collapse, scallop wars with foreign fleets, and the 200-mile limit established by the Magnuson Act. For weather, Hurricane Gloria in '85 is the perfect 80s reference,



though the Blizzard of '78 and the Perfect Storm are also strong regional memories. I should include some authentic local radio stations like WSAR and WHJY to ground it in the era. Now I'm thinking through potential titles for the game. I've got several strong candidates — Spindle City, Whaling City, South Coast, Nor'easter, The Bay State, Cranberry Coast — and I'm leaning toward something that captures that New England grit and maritime history.

But I'm realizing the key insight here: Rockstar doesn't use real city names in their games. They create fictional parody versions instead — Vice City for Miami, Liberty City for New York, Los Santos for LA. So I should follow that same approach and invent fictional names for the real places while keeping them grounded in the actual geography and character of Fall River, New Bedford, and Cape Cod. That's the authentic GTA formula. I'm settling on a hybrid approach where I use obvious parody names that clearly reference the real locations, keeping it both authentically GTA-style and accurate to the user's request. For Fall River, I'm considering names like "Mill City" or "Cordovan" that capture the industrial character while being distinctly fictional. I'm realizing I'm overthinking the naming scheme. Let me look at how Rockstar actually does it—they keep the real geographic region recognizable but give neighborhoods and specific locations punny or evocative parody names, so the

player can still map it back to the real city while enjoying the fictional layer.

Given that the user is local and wants accuracy grounded in real history, I think the best approach is to use lightly-fictionalized parody names that make the real-world references obvious, paired with dense authentic historical and geographic detail. That way it's both fun and respectful to someone who actually knows the South Coast.

Now I'm settling on the regional and city names: the umbrella region gets a fictional state nickname like "the Cod State" (playing off "Bay State" and the real historical term "Codfish Aristocracy" for Boston's wealthy families), Fall River becomes "Cascade" with the Spindle City nickname intact, and New Bedford needs a punchier fictional name—leaning toward something like "Port Hale" or "New Bedham" to keep it recognizable while adding that parody flavor.

Actually, I think the cleanest approach is to use the real city names as headers for accuracy since the user wants that representation, then add GTA-style fictional names as a secondary flourish—something like "THE SPINDLE CITY — Fictional name: Cascade. Based on: Fall River, MA." This gives both the grounded accuracy and the playful fictional twist. Rereading the prompt, it explicitly asks for parody versions and uses the word "Parody" itself, so I should lean into coining fictional names grounded in the real geography. For the region

I'll use "The South Coast," and for the cities I'm settling on "Cascade" for Fall River and "New Sefton" or "Whaleham" for New Bedford—still workshopping that last one. Okay, I'm settling on the final names: Cascade (also called Spindle City) for the Fall River parody, New Sefton (the Whaling City or Whaleport) for New Bedford, and The Forearm for Cape Cod—which is perfect because locals actually describe Cape Cod's geography as a flexed arm with distinct sections like the bicep, elbow, and forearm.

Now I'm reconsidering the Cape Cod parody more carefully. Cape Cobb works as a light play on the name, but I'm also thinking about how Vice City handles its wealthy enclaves—Starfish Island is the rich area there, and Cape Cod has its own wealthy pockets like Hyannis Port and Osterville, so I could mirror that structure in the parody world.

For the wealthy compound area, I'm leaning toward "Hyena Port" as a parody of Hyannis Port—it's funny because hyenas are predatory animals, which fits the theme of wealthy, cutthroat characters. Alternatively, "Hyland Port" works too, but "Hyena Port" has more bite to it.

For the bridges, I'm considering a few options: "the Bragga Bridge" with an extra G for the big rusted green truss structure, or "the Verde Bridge"—which is clever because verde means green in Portuguese, giving a nod to the Portuguese

community while also describing the bridge's actual green color.

For the two Canal bridges, I'm renaming the Bourne Bridge to "the Burns Bridge" and the Sagamore Bridge to "the Sachem Bridge"—sachem is a Native American chief title, which is etymologically accurate since sagamore also means a subordinate chief.

For the power plant at Brayton Point, I'm thinking "Clayton Point" instead, keeping those distinctive cooling towers as a visual landmark.

Battleship Cove becomes "Dreadnought Cove" with the USS Massachusetts reimagined as the USS Commonwealth. The Lizzie Borden house is a perfect tourist attraction to reference—I could work in the "Lizzie Borden Bed & Breakfast" as a safehouse or mission location. WHOI transforms into the "Woods Hollow Oceanographic Institute," and since they discovered the Titanic wreck in 1985, I can build a mission around a research submarine or treasure hunt. The Seamen's Bethel and Whaling Museum become "The Whalemen's Chapel."

Now I'm setting up the factions with real grounding. The Azorean Syndicate operates through fishing fleets and bakeries, drawing from the actual tight-knit Azorean immigrant community with their feasts, Portuguese clubs, and Holy Ghost societies. I'll anchor them with authentic surnames like

Medeiros, Furtado, or Sousa, and potentially add a Cape Verdean angle since that community also has roots in New Bedford.

The key is representing the real demographic split—Azoreans dominant in Fall River, Cape Verdeans stronger in New Bedford—so I'm introducing a distinct Cape Verdean faction to reflect that authentic divide. I need to be careful portraying these ethnic groups with dignity and specificity rather than stereotypes, grounding them in culture, loyalty, family bonds, food, music, and the immigrant experience itself.

For the organized crime side, I'm basing the Italian mob faction on the real Patriarca family that ran New England from Federal Hill in Providence, so I'll create a parody version with a boss character inspired by Raymond Patriarca's legendary status.

I'm also sketching in the corrupt union infrastructure—dockworkers, fishermen's unions, the rough waterfront economy—and corrupt politicians tied to that world. Now I'm mapping out the physical assets and fronts: a seafood processing plant on the docks that moves cocaine through scallop crates (pulling from actual 1980s New Bedford drug trafficking), and an abandoned textile mill that serves as a chop shop and arms depot.

I'm also adding a Cape Cod ferry service for money laundering with offshore drops, a Portuguese bakery with mob connections, and a whaling museum that launders cash

through fake donations and artifact sales. The game mechanics tie property purchases to unlocking unique mission strands for each location, each with satirical GTA-style mission names.

For vehicles, I'm pulling from the region's actual car culture — rusting 80s muscle cars with parody brand names like GTA uses, pilotable fishing trawlers, mopeds and scooters reflecting the era, lowriders from the Portuguese and Cape Verdean communities, preppy yachts, and regional details like plow trucks and Market Basket delivery runs.

For the radio stations, I'm building a classic rock format anchored around Boston bands like Aerosmith, J. Geils Band, the Cars, and Boston the band itself, mixing in national 80s arena rock staples while being careful not to reproduce actual lyrics.

Then there's a Portuguese folk and synth-pop hybrid station inspired by real New Bedford Portuguese radio, with DJs code-switching between Portuguese and English. And finally, a parody of aggressive local talk radio—something like “WRAGE”—where the host rants about fishing regulations, bridge traffic, mill closures, and local sports teams, which becomes the comedic heart of the whole thing.

For the visual direction, I'm thinking coastal neon aesthetics—flickering tavern signs from actual dive bars, lighthouse beams cutting through fog, wet cobblestones reflecting light. The palette includes New Bedford's historic

mill district with its oily dock water, orange sodium streetlights, and the green glow of the Braga bridge.

Fashion-wise, there's Portuguese fisherman sweaters mixed with Carhartt and flannel, acid-wash denim, Members Only jackets, heavy gold chains (that authentic Portuguese jewelry), big aquanet hair, and sports starter jackets alongside the preppy Cape aesthetic—Nantucket reds, boat shoes, popped collars, Lilly Pulitzer. Weather plays a big role too: nor'easters flooding roads, Hurricane Gloria-level storms, those gray raw mornings, and the occasional blinding beach day. Now I'm setting up the protagonist arriving in...

The core story beats follow Vice City's structure—a guy comes in on a scallop boat running contraband, gets betrayed at the New Sefton docks with his crew killed and the product vanishing, then has to claw his way back up. Rather than reusing Tommy Vercetti's exact arc, I need an original character. I'm torn between making him a returning local—someone Azorean-American who did time and came home—or an outsider from Providence or Boston. A returning native would give deeper local texture, but the outsider angle preserves that “arrives in new region” energy from Vice City. I think I'll go with a returning local to lean into the regional authenticity. Settling on Vincent “Vinny” Cabral as the protagonist — a local Portuguese guy who left for the Navy, returns to New Sefton in '86 looking for one last score before

getting betrayed. The name's a nice touch with the historical explorer reference, and having him be a native rather than an outsider creates better tension within the community. I need to be careful not to lift any actual GTA dialogue or mission specifics, keeping everything original. I'll use fictional family names instead—like the Camdens or Kentfields—to capture that Kennedy-esque dynasty vibe without putting actual defamatory content in real people's mouths. Same approach with the mob families: I'll create fictional analogs rather than directly libeling historical figures, though a light real-world nod works fine. Keeping the tone energetic and satirical like classic GTA voice work. I'm deciding whether to create this as a markdown file artifact or write it inline. Given the scope—a comprehensive GDD that's definitely over 20 lines and structured reference content the user will want to save—this belongs in a file. Before I create it, I should check the relevant skill documentation to make sure I'm following the right process. Markdown is the right call here—it's faster and cleaner than HTML, and matches what the user is looking for. I could offer a styled HTML version as a follow-up, but I'll keep that to a single line since it's genuinely different scope. Now I'm diving into writing the full GDD, making sure it's thorough, structured well, and captures the vision with personality.

Let me verify I'm hitting all the mandatory sections: the title and logline, the world geography with Spindle City and New



Bedford as anchors, the coastal neon aesthetic, the three main factions, the progression system with five businesses and their missions, plus vehicles and radio stations. I'll also layer in some GTA flavor—a box-art style header, a fake content rating, loading screen tips, and maybe a DLC/map note to make it feel authentic.

Now I'm drafting the markdown carefully. For the protagonist, I'm settling on Vincent “Vinny” Cabral, returning to the South Coast in autumn 1986. His arc is tight: born in New Sefton to a scalloper family, he left at eighteen for the Navy, then drifted into low-level work for the Providence LCN. He comes home in '86 to broker one major import deal through his hometown connections, but it goes sideways at the docks—ambush, money and product vanish, his crew is dead—and now he's broke and indebted to the Don.

I'm setting up the radio stations with punny mission titles in that GTA style. Three stations: The Anvil on 96.3 for classic and arena rock with DJ Iron Mike Fontaine, capturing that mill-town forge aesthetic; a Portuguese folk and synthwave hybrid station with hosts Zé do Rádio and Fátima; and The Rage on AM talk radio with Buddy Mello anchoring the local chatter. Now I'm inventing vehicle manufacturers with that same local New England flavor—quirky names like Quahog for an off-roader and Triple-Decker for a massive station wagon that plays on the iconic triple-decker houses. Also adding the Crown

Vic cop car “the Townie” and the lobster boat to the vehicle roster, plus a rating tagline “Rated M for Massachusetts.” Now I’m mapping out the Cascade neighborhood in Fall River with specific districts like the Flint, Corky Row, the Highlands, and Globe Village to ground the setting.

Moving on to New Sefton (New Bedford) with its own distinct neighborhoods—the Historic District, the Waterfront with its harbor islands, the North End with Portuguese and Cape Verdean communities, the South End, and the West End—plus Fairhollow across the river as a neighboring area. Starting to sketch out Cape Cobb on Cape Cod with Hyena Port as the main hub and other districts branching out from there.

I’m also thinking about the Route 6 aesthetic—those weathered state-highway motels, mini-golf courses, clam shacks, and drive-ins that give the area its character. And I want to weave in some local brand parodies like Donny’s Donuts and Bargain Basket to ground it in that New England feel.

Now I’m pulling together the regional dialect and food culture—things like “bubbler” for water fountain, “packie” for liquor store, “grinders” for subs, and the Rhode Island specifics like cabinets and coffee milk. The Portuguese heritage is huge here too, especially the feasts in New Bedford—the Madeira Feast and the Holy Ghost feasts with their crowns and sopas

are authentic gold. I'll sprinkle in malasadas and the religious feast traditions to add real local texture.

For sports, I'm anchoring on the 80s Patriots (that brutal Super Bowl XX loss to the Bears), the Celtics during the Bird era with the '86 championship, and Bruins loyalty. Boxing's another angle—Marvin Hagler from Brockton fighting Hearn and Leonard in the 80s, especially that legendary '87 fight with Leonard. I can use that Brockton boxer archetype as a reference point.

Now I'm writing this up with that GTA-doc energy—satirical and punchy throughout, grounding every joke in actual regional reality. I want to keep it comprehensive but tight, avoiding bloat while still hitting the detail the user is looking for.

Writing the markdown file now with the title block, six main sections, and some flavor touches like a rating and loading tips to enhance the GTA vibe without padding it out. For the chat message itself, I'll keep it brief and energetic, leading with the deliverable and offering a styled HTML version as an option. Let me verify a couple of facts I'm confident about—New Bedford as the highest-value US fishing port is solid, driven by scallops and consistently ranking #1 by value throughout the 80s.

Checking the regional details: Cape Cod's two main bridges from the '30s, plus the railroad lift bridge; Hurricane Gloria hit in September '85 which fits perfectly; the '78 blizzard is

legendary; WHOI's 1985 Titanic discovery with Ballard checks out; coffee milk and cabinets are distinctly Rhode Island/southern Massachusetts culture, which Fall River shares given its proximity to the state line; and Patriarca was the Providence mob figure tied to Federal Hill.

For the music scene, I'm anchoring on Aerosmith, J. Geils, The Cars, and Boston as the core '80s acts—Extreme formed around '85 but their big hits came later, so I'll keep the focus on the earlier bands. Portuguese feasts, particularly the Feast of the Blessed Sacrament in New Bedford, are the largest Portuguese and ethnic celebrations in the country, so that's solid regional flavor. The Quequechan River flows through Fall River (its name comes from the falling water) and is now mostly culverted underground. Brayton Point Station in Somerset has those iconic hyperbolic cooling towers that are a recognizable landmark, though I'm aware of the timeline details—I'll include them as a fictional flourish for the parody. The Canal Generating Plant in Sandwich has a distinctive tall red-and-white stack that's visible across the Cape and works as a real local landmark.

I've got solid historical references to work with: the "Codfish Aristocracy" was a real term for Boston merchant families who made their fortunes in cod fishing, which fits perfectly for satirizing Cape elite. The Cape's flexed-arm shape with

Provincetown as the “fist” is how locals actually describe it geographically.

I’m ready to write the document now. I’ll keep the DJ patter original without quoting lyrics, and aim for something that’s dense and useful without running too long.